



TIPS & TRICKS

Viewing changes as often as you choose

Very often, we need to execute a command every few seconds to view the changes made. Most of the Linux-based OSs come with a utility that enables you to view the output of a command after a set time.

```
watch -n<Seconds> 'your command here'
```

For example, if you want to view a DB table in PostgreSQL every two seconds, you can use the following command:

```
watch -n2 'psql -U postgres -d my_db -c select count(*) from order;'
```

—Deepak Gupta,
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Repositioning the cursor in Vim

Here is a tip that will help you to move the cursor on the screen:

- H – Makes it jump to the top of the screen.
- M – Makes it jump to the middle of the screen.
- L – Takes it to the bottom of the screen.

Now, if you want to reposition the cursor along with the line, you may have to try this:

- z => Repositions the cursor along with the line to the centre of the screen
- z+ => Repositions the cursor along with the line to the top of the screen
- z- => Repositions the cursor along with the line to the bottom of the screen

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Power-off after shutdown

In some Linux systems with kernel 3.5.0-*, the system will not power off after the shutdown command is passed to it. You need to press the power button continuously to halt the machine.

One possible way to fix this issue is by editing the `/etc/default/grub` file and changing the line ...

```
GRUB_CMDLINE_LINUX_DEFAULT="quiet splash"
```

...to:

```
GRUB_CMDLINE_LINUX_DEFAULT="quiet splash acpi=force"
```

Save it and update Grub by using the following command:

```
$sudo update-grub
```

If this does not work out, please downgrade your kernel to the 3.2.0-* version. To do that, first install the kernel version by using the following command:

```
$ sudo apt-get install linux-headers-3.2.0-25-generic  
linux-headers-3.2.0-25 linux-image-3.2.0-25-generic
```

Now, to make this as a default boot kernel, edit `/etc/default/grub` and change the line...

```
GRUB_DEFAULT=0
```

...to:

```
GRUB_DEFAULT=2>0
```

Save it and update Grub using the following command:

```
$ sudo update-grub
```

Reboot the machine and check that you have the correct Linux kernel by using the following command:

```
$uname -r
```

After downgrading the kernel, powering off will work perfectly.

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